

FlamingoRise

REAL TOOLS. BRIGHTER TOMORROWS.

A CALMER MIND
STARTS WITH
A SINGLE BREATH.
YOU'VE GOT THIS.



Breathing Techniques

WORKBOOK

Practical breathing techniques to help you feel calmer, reduce stress, regulate your nervous system and create more space for a brighter, more balanced you.



*Same
Brilliant You
Just Bolder*

CALM YOUR MIND

REDUCE ANXIETY

REGULATE YOUR NERVOUS SYSTEM

IMPROVE FOCUS

SLEEP BETTER

FEEL MORE IN CONTROL

SIMPLE BREATHS.
REAL CHANGE.
A BRIGHTER YOU.



BREATHING TECHNIQUES

Your breath is a tool. Not a magic wand, not a test, and definitely not something you need to do perfectly.

The original workbook had five techniques: box breathing, 4-7-8 breathing, diaphragmatic breathing, alternate-nostril breathing and Breath of Fire. The useful idea was simple: changing how you breathe can change what you notice and how you feel in the moment.

This version keeps the practical techniques but removes the promises that a particular pattern will automatically 'regulate your nervous system', reduce panic, balance your brain hemispheres or shift stagnant energy. Bodies are annoyingly individual.

Breathing exercises can feel settling for some people and uncomfortable for others. Breath holds, deep breathing or rapid breathing may cause dizziness, tingling, breathlessness or anxiety. You are allowed to stop, shorten the exercise or simply breathe normally.

Important: Never force a breath hold or keep going through dizziness, pain or significant breathlessness. If you have a respiratory, cardiovascular or other health condition, are pregnant, or are unsure whether a particular breathing exercise is suitable for you, check with an appropriate healthcare professional. This workbook is general wellbeing information, not medical treatment.

1. START WITH YOUR NORMAL BREATH

Without changing anything, what do I notice about my breathing right now?

Is it fast, slow, shallow, deep, smooth, uneven - or do I genuinely have no bloody idea?

Where do I notice movement most: chest, ribs, belly, shoulders?

Does simply paying attention feel neutral, useful or uncomfortable?

What happens if I stop trying to breathe 'correctly'?

TRY / NOTICE

Before changing your breath, learn what ordinary feels like. Observation is already a technique.

What did I notice?

2. GENTLE LONGER-EXHALE BREATHING

Does a slightly longer exhale feel comfortable for me?

What count works without strain - perhaps 3 in / 4 out, or something else?

How many rounds feel useful before I want to stop?

What do I notice afterwards?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Breathe in gently for a comfortable count, then let the exhale be a little longer. No huge gulp of air. No heroic lung performance.

What did I notice?

3. BOX BREATHING - WITH OPTIONS

How do I respond to structured counting?

Do breath holds feel comfortable or unpleasant?

Would 3-3-3-3 suit me better than 4-4-4-4?

Could I remove the holds entirely if they do not suit me?

When might a simple counting structure help me focus?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: If comfortable, inhale, pause, exhale, pause for equal easy counts. The second a hold feels strained, shorten it or remove it. The box is optional; oxygen is not.

What did I notice?

4. 4-7-8 - NOT SACRED NUMBERS

Have I tried 4-7-8 before? What happened?

Does the long hold feel easy, neutral or horrible?

Would a gentler ratio work better?

Am I treating the numbers as a target instead of listening to my body?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Only use 4-7-8 if it feels genuinely comfortable. Otherwise use shorter counts or no hold. There is no prize for making yourself dizzy because the internet said seven seconds.

What did I notice?

5. DIAPHRAGMATIC / LOWER-RIB BREATHING

Where do I feel movement when I breathe comfortably?

Can I allow my lower ribs or belly to move without forcing an enormous breath?

Does placing a hand on my ribs or belly help me notice movement?

Would practising lying down, sitting or supported make this easier?

What changes after a minute or two?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Let the inhale be easy and notice the lower ribs/belly expand naturally. Exhale without squeezing every last molecule of air out. Think 'less effort', not 'bigger breath'.

What did I notice?

6. ALTERNATE-NOSTRIL BREATHING

Does focusing on one nostril at a time help concentration or just make me annoyed?

Can I breathe comfortably through my nose today?

Do I feel light-headed, blocked or uncomfortable?

Would ordinary mindful breathing be a better option for me?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: If comfortable and your nose is clear, gently alternate which nostril you breathe through using a finger to close the other side. Keep breaths easy. We are using it as an attention exercise - not claiming it balances your brain hemispheres.

What did I notice?

7. HUMMING EXHALE

Does humming feel soothing, silly, irritating or pleasant?

Can I hum gently on a comfortable exhale without pushing?

Does the vibration give my attention somewhere useful to focus?

Would music or another sound-based technique suit me better?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Take an ordinary comfortable inhale, then hum softly as you exhale. Stop before you run out of air. Repeat a few times if it feels good.

What did I notice?

8. SIGHING & THE RESET BREATH

Do I naturally sigh when stressed, tired or frustrated?

What happens if I deliberately take one comfortable breath and let out an easy sigh?

Does one or two feel useful without turning into repeated over-breathing?

What other tiny physical reset works for me?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: One comfortable inhale, one relaxed sigh out. Maybe repeat once. Then return to normal breathing. Tiny intervention, not a competitive exhaling event.

What did I notice?

9. BREATH + MOVEMENT

Does breathing feel easier when I am moving?

Could I pair an inhale/exhale with stretching, walking, raising/lowering my arms or another safe movement?

What movement is realistic for my body today?

Does synchronising movement and breath help me focus?

TRY / NOTICE

TRY IT: Choose one comfortable movement. Let an inhale accompany one part and an exhale the other. Adapt it to your mobility, pain, energy and surroundings.

What did I notice?

10. RAPID BREATHING / 'BREATH OF FIRE': DO YOU EVEN NEED IT?

What am I hoping rapid breathing will achieve?

Have I ever felt dizzy, tingly, panicky or unwell during fast breathing?

Would movement, cold water on my face, music or ordinary paced breathing meet the same need with less faff?

Is there any good reason for ME to include this technique?

TRY / NOTICE

The old workbook included Breath of Fire for 'energy' and 'emotional release'. This edition does not prescribe rapid forced breathing. It can cause unpleasant symptoms and is unnecessary for building a useful everyday breathing toolkit.

What did I notice?

11. WHEN BREATHING EXERCISES MAKE THINGS WORSE

Do I become more anxious when I focus on my breathing?

Do breath holds make me feel trapped or air-hungry?

Does deep breathing make me dizzy or tingly?

What can I switch to instead - grounding with objects, movement, facts, sound, conversation, a practical task?

When would symptoms warrant medical advice rather than another breathing exercise?

TRY / NOTICE

You are not bad at calming down because breathwork does not suit you. Breathing is one tool in a very large toolbox.

What did I notice?

12. MY PERSONAL BREATHING MENU

The easiest technique for me is...

The one I dislike is...

A discreet technique I can use around other people is...

A technique I might use before sleep is...

A technique I might use when I need focus is...

My signs to STOP are...

My non-breathing backup technique is...

What I want Future Me to remember is...

TRY / NOTICE

Keep the menu simple enough to use when you are already stressed. If it requires a stopwatch, incense and a laminated instruction manual, we may have overdone it.

What did I notice?

7-DAY BREATHING EXPERIMENT

Tiny experiments. Comfortable breathing. Absolutely no enlightenment quota.

DAY 1: Notice your normal breathing for one minute without changing it.

DAY 2: Try a gentle longer exhale for a few rounds.

DAY 3: Try box breathing - shorten or remove holds if needed.

DAY 4: Try lower-rib/diaphragmatic breathing without forcing depth.

DAY 5: Try a humming exhale.

DAY 6: Pair comfortable breathing with safe movement.

DAY 7: Choose the one technique worth keeping - and one non-breathing backup.

FINAL REFLECTION

Which technique felt most natural?

Which technique can I happily bin?

Did any technique make me dizzy, uncomfortable or more anxious?

Do I prefer counting, sound, movement or simply noticing normal breath?

What situations might breathing exercises genuinely help me with?

What situations need a different tool or actual practical action?

What belongs on my personal breathing menu?

A FINAL FLAMINGORISE NOTE

Your breath is always with you. That makes it convenient. It does not make it magical.

Use breathing exercises when they help you pause, focus or settle. Change them when the counts feel ridiculous. Stop when your body says stop. And use a completely different tool when breathing is not the bloody answer.

The best technique is not the fanciest one. It's the one you can actually use safely and comfortably in real life.

Rise. Heal. Soar.